



ZoneAlarm firewall can keep you safe in the ways shown above

connections. ZoneAlarm does this by dividing access into two “zones”. There’s the trusted zone, which includes computers and devices such as printers connected by LAN. Then there’s the “internet zone”. The user must manually specify permissions to give to a program before it tries to access the internet. ZoneAlarm may also prompt the user for permission the first time the program attempts net access.

A freeware version is available, but there’s plenty of incentive to purchase the full versions. These are the OSFirewall and SmartDefense Advisor features. OSFirewall is present in all paid versions and monitors programs for suspicious behaviour. SmartDefense is only featured in the premium versions. It uses a large database of reliable program signatures to guide users with respect to allowing or denying program access to the internet. Different versions of ZoneAlarm also provide protection against viruses and spyware.